

RULES REPRISE: COMPENDIUM OF RATHE

Feb 5, 2026 ♦ Joshua Scott

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Tales of heroic feats, worthy deeds and uncovered schemes are described in the annals, tomes, and books found around Rathe. But no set of stories are as grand and as vast as those collected within the Compendium of Rathe. Stay a while and listen as the Rules Team's Joshua "The Tome Keeper" Scott and Niccolo "Codex Collector" Paqueo walk you through some of the finer interactions this set has to offer, so that you may write your own story and become a legend in the tapestry of Rathe's history.



MAY I CHOOSE THE ORDER OF DAMAGE BEING DEALT WITH GLYPH DESTRUCTION NODES?

Yes.

When you have an effect that does one thing to multiple different cards, you get to choose the order that those cards are affected. The order is decided right before the effect happens – after the card starts to resolve, but before existing replacement effects are applied.



Tyler controls 2 aura permanents with Sigil in their name and Nic controls Sawbones, Dock Hand. Tyler plays Glyph Destruction Nodes, targeting Nic's hero and their Sawbones. Before it resolves, Nic activates Sawbones' ability to prevent the next 1 damage dealt to either their hero or their allies. Tyler may choose the order the targets will take damage. Tyler chooses to deal damage to Sawbones first, then Nic. Sawbones takes 2 damage (1 damage prevented from Sawbones' effect) and Nic takes 3 damage.

IS TRIGGERING CONCEALED NERVE GAS/PATHOGEN/SEDATIVE OPTIONAL?

Yes, these triggered effects are optional.

The hidden triggered abilities on Concealed Nerve Gas, Concealed Pathogen, and Concealed Sedative are functional only when the card is face-down. As long as these are

face-down, these equipment's owners will always have the option to choose whether or not they want to trigger the ability, even when their trigger conditions are met. If you choose not to trigger them, they remain face-down and private. If you choose to trigger them, they will be made face-up and public, and will be added to the stack to resolve as normal.



Nic controls a face-down Concealed Nerve Gas. Tyler attacks and hits Nic with Harmonized Kodachi with go again. Nic chooses to not trigger their Concealed Nerve Gas. Tyler attacks and hits Nic again with Harmonized Kodachi with go again. Nic decides they want to trigger Concealed Nerve Gas, turning it face-up – putting a triggered layer on the stack. When the triggered effect resolves in the damage step, Nic destroys Concealed Nerve Gas and creates a Frailty token under Tyler's control.

CAN I FUSE WITH COLORS OF ARIA?

No. Colors of Aria only has the Earth, Ice, and Lightning supertypes while it is face-up in any zone.

Fusion additional costs require you to reveal a specific type of card, requiring that the card being revealed has those types BEFORE it's revealed. As Colors of Aria is still private and face-down before you perform the fusion cost of revealing a card with the specified talent, it will not have those talents and therefore not eligible to be revealed to pay for the fusion costs.

The same goes for Bravo, Star of the Show's hero ability. When Bravo's triggered effect resolves, you can reveal an Earth, Ice, and Lightning card from your hand. As the effect is

asking you to reveal cards with specific talents, Colors of Aria can't be used to satisfy this reveal effect.



Some effects that DO work with Colors of Aria:

- **Earth / Ice / Lightning Bond** – Colors of Aria will enable these bond effects because it becomes face-up and public before its placed in the pitch zone. These effects simply look at the talents of the card that was pitched.
- **Decompose** – You can banish a face-up Colors of Aria from your graveyard when resolving a decompose effect as it will have the Earth talent when face-up in the graveyard.
- **Lexi, Livewire** – Activating Lexi's cost requires you to turn a face-down card in your arsenal face-up. You can turn a face-down Colors of Aria in your arsenal face-up to satisfy this cost. When Lexi's activated ability resolves, the effect looks at what card was turned-face up. In this case because it was turned face up, it will have the Ice and Lightning talents, giving you both effects.
- **Elemental Strike** – Elemental Strike's additional cost simply asks you to banish a card; it doesn't specify the type of card that needs to be banished. Then the effect looks at what was banished. If you were to banish a Colors of Aria to pay for this, you will get all three continuous effects because Colors of Aria becomes public and face-up in your hand (getting its talents) before it is banished.



Tyler is playing as Lexi and has Colors of Aria in their arsenal and another copy in their hand. Tyler activates Lexi's ability, turning the Colors of Aria in their arsenal face-up as part of the ability's cost. When Lexi's ability resolves, because Colors of Aria is now face-up, it has the Lightning and Ice talents which result in a Frostbite for their opponent and their next attack this turn gets go again. Tyler plays Entwine Lightning (red) but cannot fuse it with the Colors of Aria in their hand as it is not a Lightning card. They must choose a different card that has the Lightning talent, then they can reveal that card to pay for the Lightning Fusion additional cost.

DOES ENFLAME THE FIREBRAND GET +2 POWER WITH 2 OTHER DRACONIC AND 1 NON-DRACONIC CHAIN LINKS?

No. The effect from Enflame the Firebrand that turns chain links Draconic does not mean it reevaluates how many Draconic chain links you control to get its third effect.

The number of chain links is evaluated only once as part of the single if-condition. Basically it operates in two parts:

- How many chain links do you control?
- These are the effects you get based on that number.



Tyler Attacks Nic with Ronin Renegade (Draconic), Ronin Renegade (Draconic), Crouching Tiger (non-Draconic), then Enflame the Firebrand (Draconic). Enflame the Firebrand's trigger goes on the stack then resolves. Tyler controls 4 chain links: 3 Draconic, 1 non-Draconic. This means Enflame the Firebrand generates 2 effects: Enflame the Firebrand gets go again, and your attacks are Draconic this combat chain. Now Tyler controls 4 Draconic chain links, but Enflame the Firebrand's trigger has finished evaluating and does NOT retroactively give Enflame the Firebrand +2 power.

WHEN I PLAY BECOME THE CUP (RED) AND CHOOSE A COLOR, DOES IT STILL COUNT AS A RED CARD BEING PLAYED?

Yes. Compendium of Rathe introduces a new phrase – “as you play this”, which allows Become the Cup to get a color and all the benefits associated with playing a card of that desired color. When you announce that you are playing Become the Cup, you will choose a color and it will gain that color, in addition to its existing colors. Then as normal, you will apply effects to the card that matches the effects' descriptions.



Tyler resolves First Tenet of Chi: Tide then plays Become the Cup (red). As they play Become the Cup, they choose the color blue. Become the Cup gets the blue color and is a blue card in addition to being red. First Tenet of Chi: Tide's continuous effect applies to it now since its a blue action card Tyler played, giving it +2 power.

Tyler resolves Prismatic Leyline then plays Become the Cup (red). As they play Become the Cup, they choose the color blue. Become the Cup gets the blue color and is a blue card in addition to being red. As it is now both colors, Prismatic Leyline's continuous effects will apply to it, giving it +4 power total (+1 for being Tyler's next red attack and +3 for being Tyler's next blue attack).

It is also worth noting that if you are under an effect that causes cards you own to lose colors (e.g. Blanch), this will cause cards you own to lose their base/printed color; however, colors gained through effects such as Become the Cup's will still have those chosen colors.

CAN HEART WRENCHER GET THE +POWER INCREASES FROM CARDS LIKE CLAMP PRESS AND FIST PUMP?

Yes! Heart Wrencher has the Wrench subtype in addition to being an attack. Effects and cards that apply to wrenches (e.g. Clamp Press) or target wrenches (e.g. Fist Pump) can interact with Heart Wrencher.

It is worth noting that it doesn't work with effects and cards that specifically look for wrench *weapons* (e.g. Construct Bank Breaker). These effects are specifically looking for a card with both the weapon type and wrench sub-type, and Heart Wrencher isn't a weapon.



CAN I USE SKERA STRAPPING’S SPELLVOID ON THE SAME ARCAINE DAMAGE EVENT THAT I USED ARCAINE BARRIER ON AND PAID FOR BY PITCHING MY FIRST CARD WITH 6 OR MORE POWER THAT TURN?

Yes. If you pitch a card with 6 or more power to use a prevention effect such as arcane barrier to reduce the damage of a single arcane damage event, you can use the spellvoid 3 from Skera Strapping to reduce any remaining arcane damage (3 or less) from that same event.



Tyler resolves a card that deals 3 arcane damage to Nic. Nic controls Skera Strapping and Shamanic Shinbones. To reduce the damage, Nic first uses the Arcane Barrier 1 on Shamanic Shinbones, pitching Aggressive Pounce (red) to pay for it. This reduces the incoming arcane damage from 3 to 2. As Aggressive Pounce has 6 power, the Spellvoid 3 on Skera Strapping becomes active, as it is always checking. Nic uses the Spellvoid 3 ability to further reduce the remaining damage down to 0.

CAN I USE MBRIO BASE VIZIER TO REMOVE MULTIPLE STEAM COUNTERS FROM ALL MY HYPER DRIVERS TO PREVENT ARCANE DAMAGE FROM A SINGLE EVENT?

No. mBrio Base Vizier's ability will apply once per event, resulting in you only being able to remove 1 steam counter from 1 Hyper Driver total. You cannot use it multiple times on the same event, even if you control multiple Hyper Drivers with steam counters.

Note, mBrio Base Vizier also has Arcane Barrier 1 on it. You can use both of those abilities once each on the same arcane damage event.



Tyler resolves a card that deals 3 arcane damage to Nic. Nic controls mBrio Base Vizier and 2 Hyper Drivers, each with 2 steam counters. Nic first uses Arcane Barrier 1 on mBrio Base Vizier, pitching a card and reducing the damage from 3 to 2. Then, Nic removes 1 steam counter from 1 Hyper Driver to prevent 1, and is dealt the remaining 1 arcane damage.

IF LUNAR MIRAGE BECOMES AN OBJECT WITH PHANTASM, WILL IT TRIGGER?

Yes, but only if Lunar Mirage becomes a copy of a defending non-Illusionist attack action card with 6 or more power and phantasm. This is because the phantasm ability's state-based triggering condition is met when the Lunar Mirage object becomes a copy of the defending attack action card with 6 or more power, thus causing it to trigger.



Tyler hits Nic with Erase Face, then follows up with Lunar Mirage. Nic defends with Embermaw Cenipai, triggering Lunar Mirage. When the triggered effect resolves, Lunar Mirage becomes a copy of the defending Embermaw Cenipai, which causes the phantasm ability on the copy to trigger, because the defending Embermaw Cenipai is a non-Illusionist card with 6 or more power.

WHEN A DEFENDING BENEATH THE SURFACE IS PUT INTO THE GRAVEYARD DOES WATERY GRAVE TRIGGER?

No. The Watery Grave ability on Beneath the Surface is not functional while defending. But it *will* trigger its second ability, which will turn it face-down in the graveyard when it resolves.



Tyler hits Nic with Command Respect (with +1 power from a Might token), which was defended by Nic's Beneath the Surface. When Command Respect's triggered effect resolves, it destroys the Bubba-Lubba, Run Aground in Nic's arsenal. Because Bubba-Lubba was not in the arena when it was destroyed, its Watery Grave ability does not trigger. When the combat chain closes, Beneath the Surface is cleared from the combat chain and its Watery Grave ability does not trigger, because it is not functional while defending and wasn't destroyed. However, by putting it into the graveyard from the arena, its second ability is triggered and turns it face-down when it resolves.

DOES CHEATING SCOUNDREL'S EFFECT ALLOW ME TO WIN ALL WAGERS IF I DO NOT HIT WITH AN ATTACK THAT HAS MULTIPLE WAGERS?

No. You will only change the result of *one* of those wagers. On a per wager basis, the hero that wins a wager is determined when that wager's triggered effect resolves during the resolution step. Under Cheating Scoundrel's effect, if you would lose a wager this turn, instead you may choose and discard a card at that point. If you discard a card this way, you will win that wager instead.

If multiple wager effects were generated, this will only change the winner of one of those wagers, not all of them. Note, the controller of the wagers' triggered effects will decide the order in which they resolve. The first one to resolve will allow that controller to win that wager, while losing the later ones.



Tyler resolves Cheating Scoundrel then attacks Nic with Wage Gold. This triggers and generates two separate wagers with the defending hero. Nic fully defends the Wage Gold and doesn't take any damage. In the resolution step, both wagers trigger and Tyler orders it so that the wager from the Wage Gold triggered effect resolves first and the wager given to Wage Gold from Cheating Scoundrel resolves second. The first wager resolves and Tyler is determined to be the loser as the attack did not hit. Then Tyler decides to apply Cheating Scoundrel's replacement effect, discarding a card to win the first wager and create a Gold token instead. When the second wager resolves, Tyler remains the loser of this wager and Nic creates a Gold token.

WILL BLESSING OF BELLONA TRIGGER AND CREATE A COURAGE TOKEN WHEN IT'S PUT INTO SOUL BY ITS OWN EFFECT?

Yes. This is similar to Merciful Retribution. With Blessing of Bellona, its third ability will trigger at the start of your turn, causing it to be put into soul. This can cause Blessing of Bellona's second ability to trigger, because the put into soul event is the triggering condition and it will see itself be put into the soul. In the end, you will create a Courage token when the triggered effect resolves.



Tyler begins their turn, triggering the “at the start of turn” triggered ability on the two Blessing of Bellona cards they control. The first triggered effect resolves putting the first Blessing of Bellona into Tyler’s soul which triggers both its own “when a card is put into your soul” triggered ability and the one on the second Blessing of Bellona. Both of these new triggered effects resolve, resulting in a Courage token for each one resolved. Lastly, the remaining “at the start of turn” triggered effect resolves, putting the second Blessing of Bellona into Tyler’s soul, and triggering its own triggered ability again thus creating another Courage token. In total, Tyler ends up with 3 Courage tokens after everything is resolved.

IF MY OPPONENT’S FIRST LIFE GAIN EFFECT IS REPLACED BY POISON THE WELL, THEN THEY HAVE ANOTHER LIFE GAIN EFFECT LATER THAT TURN, CAN VESTIGE OF FLAGELLATION REPLACE IT?

Yes. If an opponent’s first life gain effect is replaced (e.g. Poison the Well) and then they have another life gain effect later in the turn, Vestige of Flagellation can apply to that new life gain event because it would’ve been the first time they actually gained life and can be replaced.



Tyler has Vestige of Flagellation equipped. Nic plays Sigil of Solace, followed by another Sigil of Solace. Before either Sigil of Solace resolves, Tyler plays and resolves resolves Poison the Well. When the first Sigil of Solace resolves, Tyler can either use the replacement effect on Vestige of Flagellation or the one from Poison the Well. Tyler chooses the Poison the Well replacement effect to apply to the first Sigil of Solace's life gain effect, causing Nic to lose 3 life instead of gaining it. Next, the second Sigil of Solace resolves, and Tyler must apply the vestige's replacement effect here to the life gain, causing Tyler to lose 3 life and create 3 Vigor tokens.

IF I CONTROL A BLUE AURA WITH WARD, CAN I TARGET IT WITH BOTH MODES OF WAX AND WANE?

Yes. If you choose both modes of Wax and Wane, you have to target twice (a target for each mode), but they can be the same object if it fulfills the targeting description. If you do, you'll use Wax and Wane's last effect to search your deck for an Inner Chi and put it on top of your deck.



Tyler controls Cosmo, Scroll of Ancestral Tapestry, and attacks Nic with Haze Shelter (blue) in the arena they control. Tyler plays Wax and Wane, choosing both modes and targeting the attacking Haze Shelter for both modal abilities. When Wax and Wane resolves, a total of two +1 power counters are placed on Haze Shelter and Tyler searches their deck for an Inner Chi, reveals it, shuffles their deck, then finally places it on top of their deck.

IF HAVOC WRAP IS TAPPED, WILL CARDS COST LESS TO PLAY FOR ALL PLAYERS IN THE GAME?

Yes. Havoc Wrap generates several continuous effects if it is tapped. If it is tapped, cards cost 1 resource less to play, applied to *each* hero (it doesn't decrease the resource cost of activating abilities, only cards played). Additionally, as long as it is tapped, Havoc Wrap will *not* untap during the end phase; and it will get a triggered ability that triggers at the start of your turn. When this triggered effect resolves, you destroy it.



Tyler controls Havoc Wrap (tapped) and 2 Frostbite tokens. Tyler plays Sigil of Solace, which costs 1 resource to play. Its cost was increased from 0 to 2 because of the Frostbite tokens, but then reduced to 1 because of the cost reduction effect generated from Tyler's tapped Havoc Wrap.

IF I LOOK AT THE TOP OF MY DECK, WILL TOPSY TURVY PUT THAT CARD ON THE BOTTOM?

No. Looking is different to putting a card on the top of a deck: the two effects are distinct from each other.

That being said, there are a lot of cards out there with effects that may normally result in a card being put on top or bottom *after* you look at the card. Let's take a look at how Topsy Turvy interacts with these kinds of cards in most cases:

- Effects that simply let you look at the top of your deck (e.g. Dash I/O) will not be replaced by Topsy Turvy's effect.
- If you were instructed to opt 1 (e.g. Fate Foreseen) while under the effect of Topsy Turvy, you will look at the card; however, the card you look at will then be put on the bottom of your deck, because if you choose to put it on top with the opt effect it will instead be put on the bottom from Topsy Turvy's effect.
- If an effect instructs you to look at the top card of a deck and then gives you an *option* to put it on the bottom (e.g. Cut to the Chase), the card will remain on the top of the deck if you choose to *not* put it on the bottom. This is because it was not put on top, it remained on top.
- If an effect tells you to look at or reveal the top card of a deck, then has subsequent conditional effects that can result in the card being placed on either the top or bottom

of the deck (e.g. Firewall), that card will be put on the bottom of your deck under Topsy Turvy's replacement effect. If you were to normally meet the condition to put the card on top of your deck after looking at it, you would put it on the bottom instead.



It is Tyler's turn and they have Topsy Turvy equipped. Tyler attacks Nic. Nic plays Fate Foreseen, but before it resolves, Tyler activates and resolves Topsy Turvy's instant activated ability, causing cards that would be put on top of the deck to instead be put on the bottom of the deck for the remainder of the turn. Nic, who is playing Dash I/O, looks at the top card of their deck via their hero ability; however, they leave the card on top as looking is not the same as putting a card on top. When Fate Foreseen resolves, Nic opts 1; however, the card they are looking at must be put on the bottom, as the opt effect to put it on top will be replaced by Topsy Turvy.

WHAT HAPPENS IF BOTH MY OPPONENT AND I HAVE LINE CROSSERS EQUIPPED?

If both you and your opponent have Line Crossers equipped and you both have the same life as each other, both players will meet any condition that evaluates having more, the same, or less life than the other.



Tyler and Nic are both have Line Crossers equipped and each have 20 life. Tyler attacks Nic with Big Bully, triggering its effect. Because of their Line Crossers, when Big Bully's triggered effect resolves, Tyler is considered to have more life than Nic, and the crowd boos them. Then, Nic defends with two Clench the Upper Hands, triggering their abilities. Because of Nic's own Line Crossers, when each of those triggered effects resolves, the crowd will boo Nic, as they are also considered to have more life than Tyler.